

YOUR ACCUSATION OF OSKAR PRYCE DOES NOT HOLD

Not because he is a good man. He falsified a round book and he sat on a 999 call for fourteen minutes, and both of those things are true and both are on his record now.

WHAT YOUR THEORY HAS TO SURVIVE

Your theory requires Oskar Pryce to have been standing at panel B2-P1, in the Vault Level B2 corridor, at the moment the discharge was committed. **Fix that moment precisely.** Then ask where he was on either side of it, and ask by what route a man on one level reaches a panel on another without leaving a mark on anything.

You have not shown he could have been there. You have shown he behaved like a man with something to hide, which he is. It is not this.

No score is awarded for this accusation. -10 points. You have used one of your two. Go back to the table.

YOUR ACCUSATION OF DR LENA KOVALESKI DOES NOT HOLD

She lied to a police officer about what time she left a building in which a man died. That is not nothing. It is also not what you have accused her of.

WHAT YOUR THEORY HAS TO SURVIVE

Your theory requires her to have been in the building when it happened. **Two numbers decide this, and one of them is not the number printed in the autopsy.** What time did she badge out of B2 — and what time did Tobias Renn actually die?

If you are still working from the time of death on B-1, stop, and read the last box on the second page of it.

You have accused the most suspicious person in the file. That is what she is for.

No score is awarded for this accusation. -10 points. You have used one of your two. Go back to the table.

YOUR ACCUSATION OF DANNY FERRARO DOES NOT HOLD

Danny Ferraro was on a boat.

WHAT YOUR THEORY HAS TO SURVIVE

He was 190 km away, across water, on a crossing that ran three times that day and did not carry his vehicle back until 01:20. Read **E-1.2** again.

He does have something to tell you, and he told it in C-4 without being asked twice. He watched somebody open four crates behind a closed door.

No score is awarded for this accusation. -10 points. You have used one of your two. Go back to the table.

ENVELOPE S-1

Case Resolution & Final Summary

Do not open this until your Case Resolution Sheet is complete and your final accusation is written down and signed.

READING IT

One person reads the following pages **aloud, in order, without skipping ahead.** Pause after each step. Let the table check its own sheet against it as you go — the reveal is not an announcement, it is nine small verdicts on nine things you either did or did not work out.

Score afterwards, not during.

ALDENMOOR MPS · CASE REVIEW UNIT

THE DEATH OF TOBIAS RENN

STEP 1 · CAUSE

He was asphyxiated. Not poisoned, not struck, not frightened into a heart attack by a bad diagnosis he already had. The oxygen around him was taken away.

Evidence: B-1 — hypoxic asphyxia, toxicology negative throughout, airway clear, no trauma.

STEP 2 · THE FILE IS WRONG ABOUT WHEN

Everything the original investigation believed rests on one number, and that number was measured in the wrong room.

Paramedics carried Tobias Renn out of Cold Store 3 into the B2 corridor at **00:11**, to try to resuscitate him somewhere he could be resuscitated. At **00:29**, eighteen minutes later, the responding officer took the scene temperature. He took it where he was standing. **20.8 °C — B2 corridor**. It went onto the intake form. It went to the Medical Examiner. The Medical Examiner did the arithmetic perfectly.

But Renn did not die in the corridor. He died in a store held at **6.0 °C**, continuously, all evening, because the Halvorsen loan agreement says albumen prints are kept at six degrees.

Liver temperature 32.5 °C at 00:41 — a fall of 4.5 °C.

At the reference constant: $4.5 \div 0.9 = \mathbf{5.0 \text{ hours}}$ → 19:41. *This is what the file says.*

At 6 °C the multiplier is **1.94** (B-1, Appendix M).

$5.0 \div 1.94 = \mathbf{2.6 \text{ hours}}$ → **22:06**.

Tobias Renn died at about ten past ten at night, not twenty to eight. And he told you so himself: at **21:51:07** he saved a file. Two hours after the Medical Examiner has him dead, he was sitting at workstation B2-CONS-02, typing.

Evidence: B-1 (methodology + Appendix M), A-1 (reading taken in the corridor, after the body was moved), D-1 §2 (6.0 °C, continuous), D-1 §4 (21:51:07).

STEP 3 · MECHANISM

At **21:58:41** somebody stood at panel B2-P1, in the corridor outside Cold Store 3, and dumped the oxygen in that room to nine per cent by hand.

The system said there was a person inside. It said so out loud, in the log: INTERLOCK — OCCUPANCY DETECTED IN ZONE. Overriding that is not a slip. You present a Level-4 credential and you hold the override while the discharge commits. It cannot be done remotely. It cannot be done in error.

Twenty-two minutes later, at **22:20:13**, the same panel vented the room. Somebody waited outside a sealed door for twenty-two minutes and then opened it.

Evidence: SLIP 11 — full life-safety event log, both events, interlock override, oxygen trace 15.0% → 9.4% by 22:06.

STEP 4 · MEANS

Two people in that building could assert that override. Vivienne Marchetti and Oskar Pryce. Nobody else, at any level, by any route.

Evidence: E-1.1 — Level-4 roster, two holders. Note that the controller logs the credential *level* and not the individual: this narrows the case to two people and goes no further on its own.

STEP 5 · OPPORTUNITY

She did not come in through the lobby.

At **21:32:18** credential 0003 — the Facility Director's — opened the Level D service door. At **21:34:52** it called the freight elevator. At **21:35:19** the car reached Vault Level B2. At **22:30:41** it was called again, from B2. At **22:34:51** the same credential left by the same service door.

Those are the only two movements the freight car made all night, and both belong to her.

Evidence: SLIP 01. The base file already showed you the shape of this: D-1 §1 records two freight-elevator door cycles at B2, at 21:35:19 and 22:31:07, with no badge event on that level to explain either.

STEP 6 · THE ALIBI

She said she was at the Perrin Foundation dinner until a quarter past ten.

The last photograph of her at the Athenaeum is timestamped **20:16**. Her table's terminal settled at **20:20**. Her guest card was never used again. Forty guests in a floating room, and not one of them, and not one member of the venue staff, can put her anywhere at any specific moment after twenty past eight.

The Athenaeum is twenty-six minutes from Halligan Wharf. She had seventy-two.

Evidence: SLIP 08, against her own account at **C-1**.

STEP 7 · THE CLEARED

Danny Ferraro was on a boat. 190 km, no return sailing before 01:20. (E-1.2)

Dr Lena Kovalski badged out of B2 at 21:26:44, was on camera in the lobby at 21:33, and validated a transit card 6.2 km away at 21:35. Renn died at about 22:06 and the discharge fired at 21:58. **Against the time of death printed in the file, none of that clears her at all** — which is exactly why the file never looked past her. (D-1 §1, SLIP 09)

Oskar Pryce scanned Checkpoint 7 in the Level D loading bay at 21:44:11 and again at 22:02:37. The discharge was committed at 21:58:41 at a panel two floors above him. The only two routes between those levels are the freight elevator — whose only two movements that night were hers — and stairwell B2-ST1, whose alarmed fire door did not activate once between 17:30 and 00:07. **No one document clears him. Three together do.** (SLIP 03 + SLIP 11 + SLIP 01)

What Pryce was actually hiding: he was asleep off-post in the loading bay office, never walked the 22:00 round, and wrote it into the book afterwards. Then he found a body and spent fourteen minutes fixing his paperwork before he rang 999.

STEP 8 · WHY

\$412,000, in three payments, from a numbered account in Vaduz.

Four albumen prints — HB-021, HB-022, HB-030, HB-031 — sold by private treaty and replaced with modern gelatin-silver reproductions toned to look like albumen. The crates were opened and re-crated in the B2 anteroom on 14 January, off the conservation log, behind a closed door, by the Director personally, with a freight handler outside who thought it was odd and signed the manifest anyway.

The third payment cleared a called personal guarantee on a dead gallery company. The Halvorsen five-yearly condition report was commissioned twenty-four days later, because it was due, and because refusing to commission it would have been the only thing more conspicuous than commissioning it.

Evidence: SLIP 06, E-1.3, C-4, SLIP 07.

UNLAWFUL KILLING

VIVIENNE MARCHETTI

WHAT HAPPENED

He messaged her at 18:41 and she read it two minutes later, in the car, on her way to a room full of donors. *Found the problem with Halvorsen. Not damage.* She went to the dinner. She was photographed nine times. She left somewhere after twenty past eight, when forty people were standing up and moving around and nobody was looking at anybody, and she drove twenty-two kilometres and let herself in at the loading dock.

He was still working. At ten to ten he saved the fourth draft of a document that named four accession numbers and recommended notifying the insurers, and he did not send it, because he was going to send it in the morning.

She went in. Whatever was said took about three minutes. Then she stepped into the corridor, closed a door that seals, and stood at a panel that told her in plain text there was a person in the room — and she held the override down anyway.

Then she waited twenty-two minutes in an empty corridor, vented the room, went back in, and took his tablet, because the audit was on the tablet.

The audit was not on the tablet. It was on the server, saved at 21:51:07, ten minutes before she got there.

And the room she chose — the only room in the building cold enough to hold a nineteenth-century photograph — moved his death two and a half hours into a stretch of the evening she could prove she was somewhere else. She did not plan that. She got it for nothing, and it very nearly held.

It was undone by a police constable writing down the temperature of the wrong room.

SCORE THE FILE, NOT THE GUESS

Award points only for what was **written on the Case Resolution Sheet before the final accusation**. A right name with an empty sheet is a lucky guess and scores 10.

ITEM	POINTS	SCORED
Determination recorded as UNLAWFUL KILLING	+5	
Correct culprit named — Marchetti	+10	
Step 1 · Cause — hypoxic asphyxia, cited	+5	
Step 2 · Time of death — corrected to ≈22:06, cited	+5	
Step 3 · Mechanism — manual discharge, interlock overridden, cited	+5	
Step 4 · Means — Level-4 roster narrows to two, cited	+5	
Step 5 · Opportunity — Level D entry 21:32 / exit 22:34, cited	+5	
Step 6 · Contradiction — dinner corroborated only to 20:20, cited	+5	
Ferraro eliminated with evidence	+5	
Kovaleski eliminated with evidence <i>against the corrected window</i>	+5	
Pryce eliminated with evidence (all three documents cited)	+5	
Each wrong accusation	-10	
Clean Sweep — all six steps, all three eliminations, correct first time	+10	
Each unspent authority	+2	
TOTAL		

FINDINGS OF THE REVIEW

SCORE	OUTCOME
65+	CASE CLOSED — COMMENDATION. Charged, and the file will survive a defence barrister.
50-64	CHARGED. The right person, and enough working to justify it.
35-49	REFERRED. The Crown will take it and will not enjoy it.
20-34	NO FURTHER ACTION. You know. You cannot show it.
<20	THE FILE STAYS CLOSED. Accidental death. The estate absorbs the loss and Vivienne Marchetti retires to the coast.

THE QUESTION WORTH ASKING AFTERWARDS

Not "did you get it?" — but **how long did the file's own time of death go unquestioned at your table?**
That number is the case. Everything else is downstream of it.